

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

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Report Name: The Philippines Amends Policy and Allows Expansion of Fuel Ethanol Capacity

Country: Philippines

Post: Manila

Report Category: Biofuels, Sugar

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Report Highlights:

On February 11, 2025, the Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA) issued Sugar Order No. 3 (SO3), allowing new applications for construction and expansion of bioethanol facilities using molasses as feedstock provided certain conditions are met. SO3 series (s.) 2024-2025 amends SO3 s. 2015-2016, which imposed a moratorium on SRA registration of new applications or expansions of existing bioethanol plants in the country.

Background

On September 11, 2015, the SRA issued [SO3 s. 2015-2016](#) suspending the issuance of registration certificates to new applicants of molasses-based bioethanol production facilities effective marketing year (MY) 2015-2016 until such time that local molasses production exceeds the estimated requirements of existing bioethanol distilleries.

Sugar Order No. 3, s. 2024-2025

On February 11, 2025, the SRA issued [SO3](#) amending SO3 s. 2015-2016, extending the moratorium but providing the following exceptions, to wit:

- i. when a “new applicant” (i.e. new ethanol facility) has an existing sugar mill/s producing its own molasses for use as feedstock and provided that the maximum rated capacity of the new bioethanol plant does not exceed the volume of molasses produced by the sugar mill/s based on its historical record of production, or
- ii. when an application to expand existing molasses-based bioethanol facilities of sugar mills producing its own molasses provided that the maximum rated capacity of the expanded molasses-based bioethanol facilities does not exceed the volume of molasses produced by the sugar mill/s based on its historical record of production.

All existing SRA-registered bioethanol producers applying for renewal of their existing SRA registration who declare molasses as a new or additional feedstock, are exempted from the moratorium. Bioethanol producers using feedstocks other than molasses are not covered by the moratorium and are subject to policy issuances of the Department of Energy (DOE).

Molasses availability remains a constraint to expanding ethanol production (see FAS Manila’s [Biofuels Annual 2024](#)). Currently, molasses feedstock supplies about 60 percent of the ethanol requirement.

Attachments:

No Attachments.